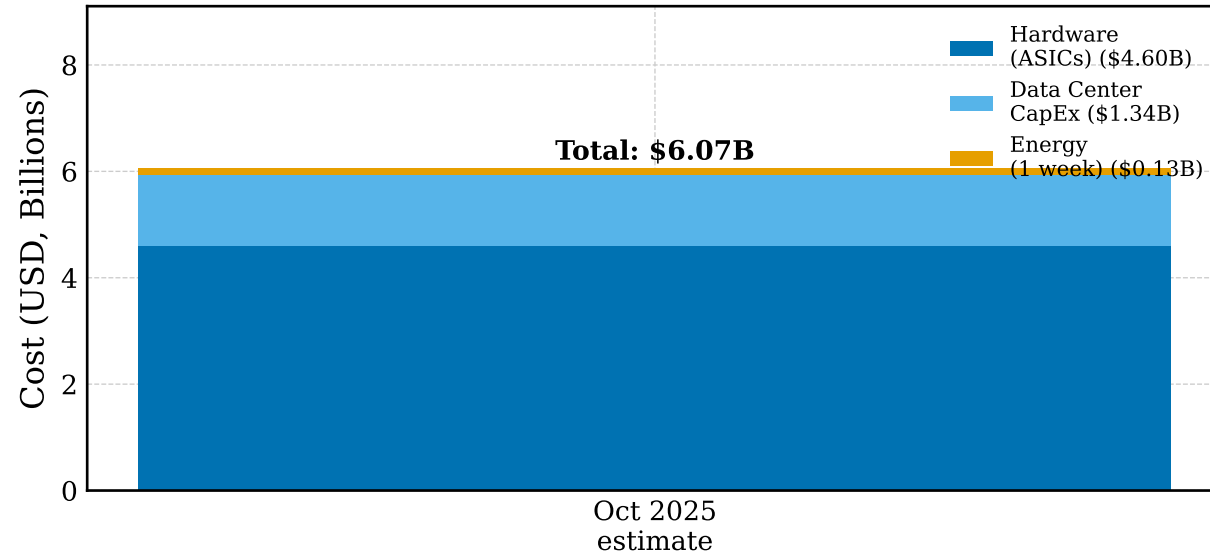
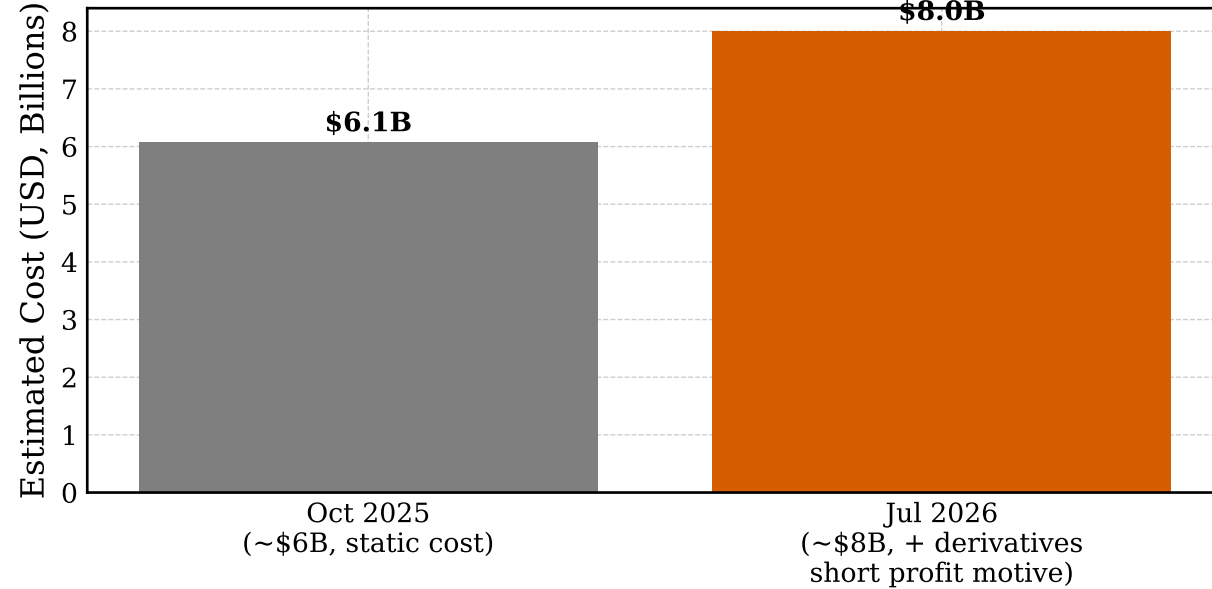


51% Attack Economics: Harvey's Own Revision (Fig. 12)

Static Hardware/Infrastructure Cost
(Harvey, Oct 2025)



The Estimate Moved Up, Not Down,
Once a Profit Motive Was Added



REPRODUCED FROM CITED SOURCES: Harvey (Oct. 2025) estimated ~\$6B in static hardware/infrastructure cost for a one-week attack. Harvey's own July 2026 update raises this to ~\$8B and adds that combining majority hashpower with a large short position in Bitcoin derivatives makes the attack a rational, profit-motivated trade rather than a costly act with no return -- a mechanism the static hardware-cost accounting omits entirely. Neither estimate accounts for hardware-supply inelasticity or grid-procurement lead times, which would push the effective cost higher still; neither accounts for the possibility of a defensive proof-of-work fork, which would push the attacker's realized payoff lower. Both estimates should be read as bounds on a moving target, not as a single settled number.